

Dear Strike Family,

I remember attending a Strike valentines day event with my friend joining Strike as a stylist my sophomore year fundamentally shifted my college experience and has been everything I was looking for and more.

Strike has given me an incomparable experience and has allowed me to express myself creatively and develop as a leader as I progressed from a Stylist to Concept Director to Creative Director. With Issue 11, I've learned to challenge my creative vision and create cohesive conceptual narratives, creating 'Mirage'. From developing 'Mirage' as an initial idea with Skye to watching the creative teams bring that vision to life, this semester has been one of the most fulfilling experiences of my time in college."

Mirage tells a story of self reflection, illusion and realization. This theme explores our relationships with ourselves and others as it forces us to look inward while navigating complex relationships, examining

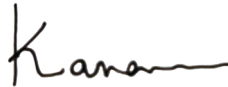
the internal and external illusions we maintain to navigate life. We battle to keep our "inner child" or our original sense of trust alive while the external world reveals its "real, darker side." We are forced to confront the difference between how we view ourselves and the reality of who we are.

Thank you to Stella, Skye and Teddy and the editors team for the constant support, ideas and laughs. I couldn't have asked for a better group of individuals to work with my last semester!

Thank you to all my creative directors for your commitment, leadership and creativity. Lastly, thank you to each and every staff member of Issue 11. The magazine wouldn't be possible without all of your hard work and dedication to Strike! the best last semester ever!!

It has truly been an honor to serve as Creative Director for Issue 11.

Strike Out
Kanan Parikh



To My Strike Family,

I first heard about Strike from the previous Layout Director, Ansley Jordan, during a study trip my freshman year. I had no idea just how much this magazine would come to mean to me.

I joined Strike as a Layout and Graphics Assistant in my sophomore year, wide-eyed and with very little experience in publication software, drawn in simply by my admiration for what Strike had built. Under the guidance of my upperclassmen on the Layout Team, I spent those early days strengthening my print design fundamentals and learning to advocate for myself and my creative decisions. I am forever grateful for the patience they showed me, and I still cherish those late nights at the Dodd, where I iterated, refined, and pushed my designs until they were something to be proud of.

To Bella and Yuree, my wonderful Layout Directors: Thank you for everything you have given to Strike, and to me. You have been endlessly kind and supportive friends throughout our time together, and I feel so lucky to have grown alongside you, both as designers and as individuals.

To the Layout Team: This magazine would not exist without your hard work and design expertise. Each of you has been an absolute joy to work with, and I have been truly amazed watching the leaps of growth and refinement you brought to every iteration.

To the Creative Team: Thank you for your dedication to this issue. Watching all of your ideas come together the way they did was one of my favorite parts of this process. You each bring something irreplaceable to this magazine, and I cannot wait to see how you continue to grow.

To the Editorial Team: It has been such a pleasure getting to know you all and collaborating on how to make this magazine the best it can be. I loved every moment of working with you this year, and I am truly sad to see some of you go.

To everyone on Strike staff: thank you. I am so proud of what we made together, and I cannot wait to see what comes next.

Strike out,

Skye Boutall



To my Strike Magazine Community,

When I first joined Strike, I never imagined how deeply this organization would shape my college experience or the person I would become. What started as something I hoped I could grow into quickly became one of the most meaningful communities in my life. Being part of Strike and especially serving in leadership has changed me in ways I will carry far beyond Athens.

Now, as I write this during my final issue in leadership with Strike, I feel an overwhelming sense of gratitude. Strike has been my creative outlet, my challenge, my support system, and my reminder that there is always space to build something meaningful alongside people who believe in the same vision. The energy in this community is unlike anything else. Whether we are in the Dodd late at night, preparing for events across campus, or bringing Issue 11 to life together, there is something electric about what each of you contributes. That spirit is what I will miss the most and what I will always try to find again wherever I go next.

To my directors, thank you for stepping into this semester with creativity, commitment, and heart. Meredith, thank you for your humor and for making every event happen no matter what came our way. Alexandra, I am so excited to watch your impact on community outreach continue to grow here. Greta, my ride or die, I am so grateful we get to step into this next chapter together. You have been one of my closest friends and strongest advocates throughout my time in Strike, and I would not be the leader I am without you. Karen C, following your journey as External Director next year will be something special to watch and I know this upcoming year will be the best one yet. Karen S, I have so much respect for you and the way you lead with thoughtfulness and care. Rachel, your organization and consistency never cease to amaze me.

To Izzy, Kadja, Karen C, and Nishika, my External Director assistants and truly my unit, thank you for making me better and more operational in every sense. I could not have done this without you.

To Stella, Kanan, and Skye, thank you for your leadership and vision in shaping what this issue has become. And to Emma, Lauren, Timothy, and Chloe, your care for this magazine and the people in it never goes unnoticed.

There are so many people who have shaped my time here in ways I will always be grateful for. To name just a few, Mary Margaret, Wesley (I love you and the experience we have shared together), Kylie, Stas, Chloe, Molley, Paige, Emily, Brandon, Pace, Kitty, Emmy, Sydney, Miles, Esha, Grace, Victoria, Eby, and Skyli, thank you for being part of what has made Strike feel like home to me throughout my time here.

Leadership in this organization has truly changed my life. It has taught me how to show up for people, how to build something bigger than myself, and how powerful it is to be surrounded by individuals who care deeply about what they create together.

To everyone in Strike, thank you for the memories, the laughter, the late nights, and the magic we continue to make together. I am so proud of this community and even more excited to see where you take it next. Good luck to everyone and stay striking.

Strike Out,

Teddy Goldstein
Issue 11 External Director
Strike Magazine Athens

Thornton Robert Goldstein



Issue 11 Directors



Foam crests as the waves lull towards the shore, bubbling like children's laughter, yet salty like their tears. The sun warms the shore, gracing those who lie upon it with a pink and tan flush. Feathers flap as creatures soar through the air, playing in the breeze.

Sandcastles

Along the shore, in the damp, cool sand, four small, uncoordinated hands work tirelessly to build the castle of their dreams. Toothless grins punctuate the ends of unsaid sentences. Salt dries in the hair that their parents will lovingly comb through tonight, yet it will still hurt. But that doesn't matter now. Their castle prevails. Short legs, yet to be scarred by unavoidable falls, carry them to and from the waves, pawing at their feet, carrying water in uncalloused hands cupped together like a prayer. The cement to their sand house of dreams.





Do Butterflies Remember Being Caterpillars?

There was no day I stopped kneeling to look closely. No day I decided Wonder was childish. It slipped quietly, like a season changing while I was indoors.

I remember how intensely I used to notice things. The way a caterpillar's body folded in on itself when it moved, the exact green of a new leaf. Now, I remember remembering them more than I remember these moments themselves.

If nothing is remembered consciously, where does the past go?

I used to keep caterpillars in glass jars with holes punched into the lid. I fed them leaves and checked on them constantly, afraid they might change when I wasn't looking. What I wanted to know was simple: when they emerged with wings, would they remember the bodies they left behind? Would they know they had once crawled?

I kept these questions with me. They followed me long after I stopped collecting jars.

There was no distinct moment when my attention changed. No single day when the world became less vivid. I stopped kneeling to examine caterpillars. I stopped collecting what I found.

My curiosity didn't vanish; it quieted, settling somewhere out of my grasp. I can't locate when this happened—I only know I used to notice more than I do now.

Perhaps transformation is not a replacement, but a redistribution. What dissolves does not vanish, but rearranges. My earlier self does not remain intact; my self is not locked away in a keepsake box, waiting to be used later. She is metabolized into what comes next.

I think back to jars on windowsills and the patience watching them required. I was searching for proof that change did not mean disappearance. I wanted continuity that I could see. I imagined memory as a thread—stretching unbroken from one form to the next. But transformation was never about preserving a thread. The caterpillar does not carry its past forward as a story. It carries it as a structure.

Reorganized, invisible, indispensable.

I can't clearly picture who I was when I first asked these questions. The intensity of her noticing is inaccessible to me now. But I recognize her influence in the way I still look closely, in the quiet pull toward transformation, in the unease that accompanies change and the steadiness that follows it.

I once believed the miracle was the wings. Now I think it is the persistence of what can't be seen.

I still don't know whether butterflies remember being caterpillars. But I know everything with wings emerges from something. What once crawled is not remembered in detail; it is built into what flies. And what I have been, though no longer visible to me in the same way, continues in the shape of who I am becoming.

No one can tell me whether butterflies remember being caterpillars, only how they change.

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Issue 11 Film

